

ML Unit 1

Machine Learning and Applications - Unit 1

Complete Notes

Part 1: Foundations

1. Introduction to Machine Learning

What is Machine Learning?

Definition: Machine Learning is the science of getting computers to learn without being explicitly programmed.

Key Characteristics:

- Ability to **learn and improve from experience**
- New capability for computers to **mimic human decision-making**
- Focus on pattern recognition and prediction rather than explicit programming

Course Outcomes

Students completing this course should be able to:

1. Use effective machine learning techniques for various applications
 2. Identify characteristics of datasets and choose appropriate learning models
 3. Implement practical machine learning algorithms
 4. Evaluate learning methods and relate them to particular problems
 5. Design practical machine learning systems and apply ML to projects
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2. Why Machine Learning?

Success Factors

Machine learning has become successful due to three main factors:

1. Abundant Data

- Massive amounts of data generated daily
- Diverse data sources (sensors, social media, transactions, etc.)
- Improved data collection and storage capabilities

2. Availability of Models and Algorithms

- Extensive research and development
- Open-source libraries and frameworks
- Proven algorithms for various tasks

3. Fast and Cheap Computing

- Cloud computing infrastructure
- GPU acceleration for parallel processing
- Cost-effective computational resources

Problem-Solving Approach

Why use ML instead of traditional programming?

1. **Hard to write explicit programs** for complex tasks like face recognition
2. We don't fully understand how our brain solves certain problems
3. Even if we understood, the program might be **horrendously complicated**

ML Solution:

- Collect **lots of examples** that specify correct output for given input
 - ML algorithm takes these examples and **produces a program**
 - The learned program may contain **millions of numbers** (parameters)
 - If done correctly, the program **generalizes** to new, unseen cases
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3. Applications of Machine Learning

Pattern Recognition

- **Facial recognition** - identity and expression detection
- **Handwritten/spoken word** recognition
- **Medical imaging** - disease diagnosis and analysis

Pattern Generation

- Generating images or motion sequences
- Creative applications (art, music)

Anomaly Detection

- **Credit card fraud** - unusual transaction patterns
- **Industrial monitoring** - nuclear power plant sensors

- **Automotive diagnostics** - unusual engine sounds

Prediction Tasks

- **Financial forecasting** - stock prices, currency exchange rates
- **Weather prediction**
- **Sales forecasting**

Web-Based Applications

- **Spam filtering** - adaptive to evolving spam techniques
 - **Fraud detection** - enemy adapts, system must adapt
 - **Recommendation systems** - handling noisy data
 - **Information retrieval** - finding similar documents/images
 - **Data visualization** - revealing patterns using techniques like Latent Semantic Analysis
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4. Types of Learning

1. Supervised Learning

Definition: Learn to predict output when given an input vector

Characteristics:

- Training data includes both **inputs (features)** and **outputs (labels)**
- Model learns the **mapping function** from input to output
- Used for **classification** and **regression** tasks

Example: Predicting house prices based on features (size, location, etc.)

2. Unsupervised Learning

Definition: Create internal representation of input (e.g., form clusters, extract features)

Characteristics:

- **No labeled outputs** provided
- Model discovers **hidden patterns** or structure
- Challenging to evaluate - "How do we know if representation is good?"
- **New frontier** of ML - most big datasets lack labels

Example 1: Customer Segmentation

- Shopping mall groups customers based on annual income and spending score

- No predefined labels like "High spender" or "Low spender"
- Algorithm: K-Means Clustering
- Results:
 - Cluster 1: Low Income – Low Spending
 - Cluster 2: High Income – High Spending

Example 2: Image Segmentation

- Dividing an image into meaningful regions
- Each pixel treated as a data point
- No ground-truth segmentation given
- Model discovers structure based on pixel similarity

3. Reinforcement Learning

Definition: Learn action to maximize payoff/reward through trial and error

Characteristics:

- Agent learns through **interaction** with environment
- Receives **rewards or penalties**
- **Limited information** in payoff signal
- Payoff is often **delayed** (temporal credit assignment problem)

Applications:

- Game playing (Chess, Go)
- Robotics
- Autonomous vehicles

5. Classification vs Regression

Classification

Definition: Predict **discrete class labels**

Characteristics:

- Output is **categorical** (finite set of classes)
- Can be **binary** (2 classes) or **multi-class** (>2 classes)

Examples:

- **Medical diagnosis** - # classes = # diseases

- **Spam detection** - # classes = 2 (spam vs. not spam)
- **Image classification** - object recognition

Regression

Definition: Predict **continuous numerical values**

Characteristics:

- Output is a **real number**
- Establishes **relationship** between variables

Univariate Regression:

- Single independent variable
- Example: Height vs. Weight prediction

Multivariate Regression:

- Multiple independent variables
- Example: Housing dataset with multiple features

Real-World Example: Marketing company tracks:

- Advertisement spending: [100, 150, 200, 250, 300]
- Corresponding sales: [500, 750, 1000, 1250, 1500]
- **Goal:** Predict sales for \$200 advertisement in 2026

Other Examples:

- House price prediction
 - Weather forecasting
 - Electricity consumption
 - Age estimation
 - Traffic flow prediction
 - Heart rate/blood pressure prediction
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Part 2: Data Management

6. Data Splitting Strategy

Critical Concept: Split data into training, validation, and test sets for proper model development

Why Split Data?

Using a single dataset can cause:

- **Overfitting:** Model memorizes data but fails on new inputs
- **Biased performance estimates**
- **Poor generalization**

Splitting ensures:

- Fair evaluation
- Better generalization to unseen data
- Reliable performance metrics

1. Training Set (~60-70% of data)

Purpose: Learning the patterns

What happens:

- Model fits parameters (weights, biases, tree splits, etc.)
- Errors are minimized using optimization algorithms
- Model learns relationship between inputs (features) and outputs (labels)

Why needed:

- Without training data, the model cannot learn anything
- Foundation for all subsequent model development

2. Validation Set (~15-20% of data)

Purpose: Tuning and model selection

What happens:

- Adjust **hyperparameters** (learning rate, number of layers, k in k-NN)
- Decide **when to stop training** (early stopping)
- **Compare** different models or configurations

Why needed:

- Prevents **overfitting** to training data
- Ensures decisions are **not biased** by test set
- Allows iterative model improvement

3. Test Set (~15-20% of data)

Purpose: Final unbiased evaluation

What happens:

- Provides **unbiased estimate** of real-world performance
- **No learning or tuning** done using test data
- Used **only once** to evaluate final model

Why needed:

- If test data influences training, results become **misleading and overly optimistic**
- Ensures honest performance reporting

Important Considerations

Multiple Runs Needed:

1. Training and validation sets might contain misleading factors (noise, outliers)
2. Learning method may depend on random factors (e.g., initial weights in MLP)
3. Run many times and average results to overcome randomness

Using scikit-learn:

```
from sklearn.datasets import make_blobs
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split

# create dataset
X, y = make_blobs(n_samples=1000)

# split into train test sets
X_train, X_test, y_train, y_test = train_test_split(X, y, test_size=0.33)
print(X_train.shape, X_test.shape, y_train.shape, y_test.shape)
# Output: (670, 2) (330, 2) (670,) (330,)
```

7. Practical Student Pass/Fail Example

Problem Statement

Predict whether a student will **Pass (1)** or **Fail (0)** based on **hours studied**

Dataset

- 10 labeled data points total
- Feature: Hours studied
- Label: Pass/Fail

Training Phase (6 data points)

Model learns:

- Low study hours → Fail
- Higher study hours → Pass
- **Decision boundary** learned ≈ 4.5 hours
- Model fitted **only using training data**

Validation Phase (2 data points)

Purpose: Test different model settings

- Test threshold = 4 hours vs. threshold = 5 hours
- Choose model with **better validation accuracy**
- Helps **avoid overfitting** and select best configuration

Testing Phase (2 data points)

Final Evaluation:

- Accuracy on test set = 100%
- Test data **never used** during training or tuning
- Provides **unbiased performance** estimate

Part 3: Learning Theory

8. Learning Class From Examples

Example: Family Car Classification

Problem Setup:

- Class C = Family car
- Features: Price (x_1) and Engine Power (x_2)
- Positive examples (+): Cars within acceptable range
- Negative examples (-): Cars outside acceptable range

Example Ranges:

- $x_1' = 4$ lakhs to $x_1 = 14$ lakhs (Price)
- $x_2' = 2$ hp to $x_2 = 8$ hp (Engine Power)

Formal Representation

Each car represented by:

$$\mathbf{x} = [x_1, x_2]^T$$

where x_1 = Price, x_2 = Engine Power

Labeling:

$$r = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x \text{ is positive example} \\ 0 & \text{if } x \text{ is negative example} \end{cases}$$

Training Set:

$$X = \{(x^t, r^t)\}_{t=1}^{t=N}$$

Hypothesis Class

Let H be the hypothesis class:

$$H: (p_1 \leq \text{price} \leq p_2) \text{ AND } (e_1 \leq \text{Engine Power} \leq e_2)$$

Where:

- p_1 = Lower limit of price
- p_2 = Upper limit of price
- e_1 = Lower limit of engine power
- e_2 = Upper limit of engine power

Example:

$$(4 \text{ lakh} \leq \text{price} \leq 14 \text{ lakh}) \text{ AND } (2 \leq \text{Engine Power} \leq 8)$$

Learning Algorithm

The learning algorithm finds hypothesis $h \in H$ specified by $(p_1^h, p_2^h, e_1^h, e_2^h)$

Goal: Find $h \in H$ that is as similar as possible to C

Hypothesis Function:

$$h(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } h \text{ classifies } x \text{ as positive} \\ 0 & \text{if } h \text{ classifies } x \text{ as negative} \end{cases}$$

Empirical Error

Error of hypothesis h given training set X :

$$E(h|X) = \sum_{t=1}^{t=N} 1(h(x^t) \neq r^t)$$

Where:

$$1(h(x^t) \neq r^t) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } h(x^t) \neq r^t \\ 0 & \text{if } h(x^t) = r^t \end{cases}$$

Goal: Select h such that $E = 0$

Version Space

Most Specific Hypothesis (S):

- Tightest rectangle covering all positive examples
- Example: $8 \text{ lakh} \leq \text{price} \leq 10 \text{ lakh}$ AND $(4 \leq \text{Engine Power} \leq 6)$

Most General Hypothesis (G):

- Loosest rectangle covering all positive examples
- Example: $4 \text{ lakh} \leq \text{price} \leq 14 \text{ lakh}$ AND $(2 \leq \text{Engine Power} \leq 8)$

Version Space:

- Any $h \in H$ between S and G
- All hypotheses consistent with training set (zero error)

True Class C (unknown):

$C: 4 \text{ lakh} \leq \text{price} \leq 13 \text{ lakh}$ AND $(2.5 \leq \text{Engine Power} \leq 7.5)$

Errors in Classification

False Negative:

- Point where $C = 1$ but $h = 0$
- Example: Price = 12.75 lakhs, Engine Power = 4
- Actual class says positive, but hypothesis says negative

False Positive:

- Point where $C = 0$ but $h = 1$
- Example: Price = 10 lakhs, Engine Power = 7.9
- Actual class says negative, but hypothesis says positive

S-Set and G-Set

In reality, there may be multiple specific and general hypotheses:

S-Set:

- Several S_i make up S-Set
- Every member is consistent with all instances
- No consistent hypothesis more specific exists

G-Set:

- Several G_j make up G-Set
- Every member is consistent with all instances
- No consistent hypothesis more general exists

Version Space: All hypotheses between S-Set and G-Set

Candidate Elimination Algorithm:

- Incrementally updates S-Set and G-Set
- Processes training instances one by one
- Assumption: Training set large enough for unique S and G

Margin and Doubt

Margin:

- Choose hypothesis with **largest margin** for best separation
- Shaded instances define margin
- Other instances can be removed without affecting h
- Maximizes separation between classes

Doubt (Reject Option):

- Hypothesis falls between S and G
- Cannot label due to lack of data
- System rejects instance and defers to human expert
- Example: h between S and G with intermediate boundaries

9. Vapnik-Chervonenkis (VC) Dimension

Definition

VC Dimension:

- Measure of the capacity (complexity) of a hypothesis class
- Maximum number of points that can be **shattered** by H

What is "Shattering"?

Definition: A set of points is **shattered** by a hypothesis class if all possible labelings of those points can be correctly classified by some hypothesis in the class.

For n points:

- Total possible labelings = 2^n
- If model can represent all labelings $\rightarrow$ points are shattered

Why VC Dimension is Important

VC dimension helps to:

1. **Measure model complexity**
2. **Understand overfitting vs generalization**
3. **Provide theoretical guarantees** on learning
4. **Choose appropriate model** for given data

Examples

1. Threshold Classifier on a Line

Model:

$$h(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x \geq c \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

VC Dimension = 1

- 1 point $\rightarrow$ can be labeled as 0 or 1
- 2 points $\rightarrow$ cannot realize all labelings

2. Linear Classifier in 2D

VC Dimension = 3

- 3 non-collinear points $\rightarrow$ All $2^3 = 8$ labelings possible
- 4 points $\rightarrow$ Some labelings cannot be separated by a line
- Example: XOR problem cannot be solved by linear classifier

3. Linear Classifier in d Dimensions

General Formula:

$$\text{VC Dimension} = d + 1$$

Examples:

- $2D \rightarrow VC = 3$
- $3D \rightarrow VC = 4$

4. Axis-Aligned Rectangle in 2D

VC Dimension = 4

- Can shatter 4 points
- Cannot shatter 5 points

Intuitive Understanding

Low VC dimension:

- Simple model
- May underfit
- Fewer training samples needed

High VC dimension:

- Complex model
- Risk of overfitting
- More training samples needed

VC Dimension and Generalization

Generalization error depends on:

1. Training error
2. VC dimension
3. Number of training samples

Key Insight:

- Higher VC dimension requires **more training data** to generalize well
- Trade-off between model complexity and data requirements

Limitations

1. **Hard to compute** for complex models
2. **Mostly theoretical** - difficult to apply in practice
3. **Loose bounds** in practice - often too conservative

10. PAC Learning (Probably Approximately Correct)

Basic Concept

PAC Learning Framework: A theoretical framework that defines when a learning algorithm can be considered successful.

PAC stands for:

- **Probably** → with high probability
- **Approximately** → small error allowed
- **Correct** → close to the true concept

The Problem

Goal: Find number of examples N such that with probability $(1-\delta)$, hypothesis h has error at most ϵ

Mathematical Formulation:

$$P(C \Delta h \leq \epsilon) = 1 - \delta$$

Where:

- $C \Delta h$ = Region of difference between C and h
- ϵ = Error bound (accuracy parameter)
- δ = Confidence parameter

Derivation for Rectangle Hypothesis

Setup:

- $h = S$ (tightest possible rectangle)
- Error region = sum of four rectangular strips

Step-by-Step:

1. Probability that each positive example falls in strip = $\epsilon/4$
2. Probability that example misses strip = $1 - \epsilon/4$
3. Probability N examples miss one strip = $(1 - \epsilon/4)^N$
4. Probability N examples miss all four strips = $4(1 - \epsilon/4)^N$

Using approximation:

$$(1 - \epsilon/4)^N \approx e^{(-\epsilon N/4)}$$

Setting bound:

$$\begin{aligned}
4e^{(-\epsilon N/4)} &\leq \delta \\
e^{(-\epsilon N/4)} &\leq \delta/4 \\
-\epsilon N/4 &\leq \ln(\delta/4) \\
N &\geq (4/\epsilon) \ln(4/\delta)
\end{aligned}$$

Interpretation

Sample Complexity:

$$N \geq (4/\epsilon) \ln(4/\delta)$$

Insights:

1. As δ decreases (higher confidence) $\rightarrow$ N increases
2. As ϵ decreases (lower error) $\rightarrow$ N increases
3. Polynomial relationship with $1/\epsilon$ and $\log(1/\delta)$

Formal PAC Definition

A hypothesis class H is **PAC-learnable** if for:

- Error bound $\epsilon > 0$
- Confidence bound $\delta > 0$

There exists a learning algorithm A such that:

$$P(\text{error}(h) \leq \epsilon) \geq 1 - \delta$$

using a **polynomial number** of samples.

Numerical Example

Assume:

- $\epsilon = 0.05$ (5% error allowed)
- $\delta = 0.01$ (99% confidence)

Meaning: With 99% probability, the learned model's error will be $\leq 5\%$ on unseen data.

Role of VC Dimension

Sample complexity depends on VC dimension (d):

$$m = O\left(\frac{1}{\epsilon} (d \cdot \log(1/\epsilon) + \log(1/\delta))\right)$$

Where:

- d = VC dimension
- Higher VC $\rightarrow$ more samples needed

Examples of PAC-Learnable Models

1. Threshold Functions on a Line

- VC dimension = 1
- Requires few samples
- PAC-learnable

2. Linear Classifiers

- Finite VC dimension
- PAC-learnable

Why PAC Learning is Important

1. **Theoretical guarantee** of learning
 2. **Connects** model complexity and generalization
 3. **Explains** why some models need more data
 4. **Foundation** of learning theory
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11. Noise in Machine Learning

What is Noise?

Definition: Noise is an unwanted anomaly in the data. Due to noise, the class may be difficult to learn and zero error may be impossible with a simple hypothesis class.

Types of Noise

1. Input Noise

Imprecision in recording input attributes

- Shifts data points in input space
- Measurement errors
- Sensor inaccuracies

2. Label Noise (Teacher's Noise)

Errors in labeling data points

- Relabels positive examples as negative (and vice versa)

- Human annotation errors
- Ambiguous boundary cases

3. Hidden/Latent Variables

Additional attributes not taken into account

- Attributes that affect the label
- May be unobservable
- Effect modeled as random component
- Included in noise term

Effect of Noise

Without noise:

- Simple hypothesis (e.g., rectangle) works well
- Clean separation possible

With noise:

- Need complicated hypothesis to separate instances
- Risk of overfitting to noise
- Zero error may be impossible

Why Use Simple Models Despite Noise?

Occam's Razor Principle: Given comparable empirical error, a simple model generalizes better than a complex model.

Reasons for simplicity:

1. Easy to use

- Simple to check (e.g., point inside/outside rectangle)
- Fast prediction for future instances

2. Simple to train

- Fewer parameters to estimate
- Easier optimization
- Less variance, more bias
- Optimal model minimizes both bias and variance

3. Simple to explain

- Rectangle = defining intervals on attributes
- Interpretable results
- Can extract information from raw data

4. Better generalization

- If actual class is simple (e.g., rectangle)
- Resists overfitting to noise
- More robust to variations

12. Learning Multiple Classes

Problem Setup

K Classes: $C_1, C_2, \dots, C_k$

Example:

- Class C_1 = Family Car
- Class C_2 = Luxury Car
- Class C_3 = Sports Car

Representation

Training Set:

$$X = \{(x^t, r^t)\}_{t=1}^N$$

Where r is K-dimensional:

$$r^t_i = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x^t \in C_i \\ 0 & \text{if } x^t \in C_j \text{ for } j \neq i \end{cases}$$

K Hypotheses

Learn K hypotheses $\{h_1, h_2, \dots, h_k\}$ such that:

$$h_i(x^t) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x^t \in C_i \\ 0 & \text{if } x^t \in C_j \text{ for } j \neq i \end{cases}$$

Strategy:

- For each class C_i , positive instances = class C_i
- Negative instances = all other classes
- Learn boundary separating C_i from rest

Total Empirical Error

Formula:

$$E(\{h_i\}_{i=1}^K | X) = \sum_{t=1}^N \sum_{i=1}^K 1(h_i(x^t) \neq r^t_i)$$

Where:

- K = Number of classes
- N = Number of instances

Decision Cases

For a given x:

Case 1: Ideal

- Only one $h_i(x) = 1$
- Clear classification

Case 2: Ambiguous

- Two or more $h_i(x) = 1$
- Cannot choose unique class
- Need tie-breaking strategy

Case 3: Doubt/Reject

- No $h_i(x) = 1$
- Insufficient confidence
- Classifier rejects instance
- Defer to human expert

Part 4: Model Evaluation

13. Model Evaluation & Performance Metrics

Why Evaluate?

Two Key Questions:

1. **How can we assess expected error** of a learning algorithm?
 - Given a trained classifier on a dataset
 - How confident are we about real-life error rate?
2. **How can we compare** two learning algorithms?
 - For a given problem
 - Which is better: MLP or k-NN?

Important Principles

Training error is NOT a deciding factor:

- Error on training set < Error on testing set
- More complex model with more parameters → lower training error
- But may not generalize well

Always use validation set:

- Not just one run - multiple runs needed
- Average results to overcome randomness
- Training and validation sets may contain noise/outliers

Multiple runs needed because:

1. Small datasets may have misleading factors
2. Learning method depends on random factors
3. Example: MLP with backprop converges to local minimum
4. Initial weights affect final weights → different error rates

Process:

1 training = 1 learner + 1 validation error
Multiple trainings → Multiple learners → Distribution of errors
Evaluation based on this distribution

14. Confusion Matrix

Basic Concepts

For binary classification:

True Positive (TP):

- Predicted value matches actual value
- Actual = Positive, Predicted = Positive

True Negative (TN):

- Predicted value matches actual value
- Actual = Negative, Predicted = Negative

False Positive (FP) - Type 1 Error:

- Predicted value was falsely predicted
- Actual = Negative, Predicted = Positive
- Also called "False Alarm"

False Negative (FN) - Type 2 Error:

- Predicted value was falsely predicted
- Actual = Positive, Predicted = Negative
- Also called "Miss"

Example

Dataset: 1000 data points

Confusion Matrix:

		Predicted	
		Pos	Neg
Actual	Pos	560	50
	Neg	60	330

Values:

- TP = 560 (positive correctly classified)
- TN = 330 (negative correctly classified)
- FP = 60 (negative incorrectly classified as positive)
- FN = 50 (positive incorrectly classified as negative)

Assessment: Decent classifier with relatively large TP and TN values

Performance Metrics

Accuracy:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Accuracy} &= (TP + TN) / (TP + TN + FP + FN) \\
 &= (560 + 330) / 1000 \\
 &= 0.89 \text{ or } 89\%
 \end{aligned}$$

True Positive Rate (Sensitivity, Recall, Hit Rate):

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{TPR} &= TP / (TP + FN) \\
 &= 560 / (560 + 50) \\
 &= 0.918 \text{ or } 91.8\%
 \end{aligned}$$

Measures proportion of actual positives correctly identified.

False Positive Rate (False Alarm Rate):

$$\begin{aligned}\text{FPR} &= \text{FP} / (\text{FP} + \text{TN}) \\ &= 60 / (60 + 330) \\ &= 0.154 \text{ or } 15.4\%\end{aligned}$$

Measures proportion of actual negatives incorrectly identified as positive.

Specificity:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Specificity} &= \text{TN} / (\text{TN} + \text{FP}) = 1 - \text{FPR} \\ &= 330 / (330 + 60) \\ &= 0.846 \text{ or } 84.6\%\end{aligned}$$

How well we detect negatives.

Multi-Class Confusion Matrix

For $K > 2$ classes:

- $K \times K$ matrix
- Entry (i, j) = number of instances belonging to C_i but assigned to C_j
- **Ideally:** All off-diagonals should be 0 (no misclassification)
- Allows pinpointing what types of misclassification occur

15. ROC Curves and AUC

Receiver Operating Characteristics (ROC)

Concept:

- For different threshold values θ
- Get pairs of (TPR, FPR) values
- Plot these pairs to create ROC curve

Decision Rule:

Choose positive if $P(\text{positive}|x) / P(\text{negative}|x) > \theta$

ROC Curve Analysis

Perfect Classifier:

- $\text{TPR} = 1, \text{FPR} = 0$

- Point at upper-left corner

Better Classifier:

- ROC curve closer to upper-left corner
- Higher TPR for same FPR

Comparing Two Classifiers:

- One is better if its ROC curve is above the other
- If curves intersect: different classifiers better under different loss conditions

Area Under Curve (AUC)

Purpose: Reduce ROC curve to single number for comparison

Interpretation:

- AUC = 1: Perfect classifier
 - AUC = 0.5: Random classifier
 - Higher AUC = Better classifier
-

16. Precision, Recall, and F1-Score

Information Retrieval Context

Scenario:

- Database of records
- Make query (e.g., keywords)
- System returns records (two-class classifier)

Outcomes:

- **True Positives:** Retrieved AND relevant
- **False Positives:** Retrieved but NOT relevant
- **False Negatives:** NOT retrieved but relevant
- **True Negatives:** NOT retrieved and NOT relevant

Precision

Definition:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Precision} &= (\text{Retrieved AND Relevant}) / \text{Total Retrieved} \\ &= TP / (TP + FP)\end{aligned}$$

Meaning:

- What proportion of retrieved records are relevant?
- If precision = 1: All retrieved may be relevant
- But there may be relevant records not retrieved

Recall

Definition:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Recall} &= (\text{Retrieved AND Relevant}) / \text{Total Relevant} \\ &= \text{TP} / (\text{TP} + \text{FN})\end{aligned}$$

Meaning:

- What proportion of relevant records are retrieved?
- Same as Sensitivity and TPR
- If recall = 1: All relevant may be retrieved
- But there may be irrelevant records retrieved

F1-Score

Definition:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{F1-Score} &= 2 \times (\text{Precision} \times \text{Recall}) / (\text{Precision} + \text{Recall}) \\ &= 2\text{TP} / (2\text{TP} + \text{FP} + \text{FN})\end{aligned}$$

Meaning:

- Harmonic mean of Precision and Recall
- Balances both metrics
- Good for imbalanced datasets

Relationships

Sensitivity = TPR = Recall

$$\text{All three measure: } \text{TP} / (\text{TP} + \text{FN})$$

Specificity:

$$\text{Specificity} = \text{TN} / (\text{TN} + \text{FP}) = 1 - \text{FPR}$$

Trade-offs

High Precision, Low Recall:

- Conservative system
- Returns few results, but mostly relevant

Low Precision, High Recall:

- Liberal system
- Returns many results, but includes irrelevant ones

F1-Score:

- Optimizes balance
 - Useful when need both precision and recall
-

Part 5: Regression

17. Parametric Methods

What is a Parametric Method?

Definition: An approach that assumes a **fixed form (structure)** for the model and summarizes data using a **finite set of parameters**.

Key Characteristics:

1. Assumes specific form for the model
2. Uses finite set of parameters
3. Once parameters learned, **dataset can be discarded**
4. Model fully defined by parameters

Example: Linear Regression

Problem: Predict sales based on advertisement

Hypothesis:

$$\text{Sales} = w_0 + w_1 \times \text{Advertisement}$$

Parameters:

- w_0 : Intercept
- w_1 : Slope

Parametric Nature:

- Once w_0 and w_1 are learned
 - Labeled dataset can be discarded
 - Model completely specified by two numbers
-

18. Regression Analysis

Basic Concept

In Classification:

- Output is Boolean

In Regression:

- Output is a **numeric function**

Problem Setup

Training Set:

$$X = \{(x^t, r^t)\}_{t=1}^N$$

Goal: Find function $f(x)$ such that $r^t = f(x^t)$

Types of Problems

1. Interpolation (No Noise):

- Find function passing through all points
- Task: fit function to data

2. Polynomial Interpolation:

- Given N points
- Find $(N-1)$ degree polynomial
- Can predict for any x

3. Extrapolation:

- Prediction when x is outside range of x^t in training set
- Extends beyond observed data

4. Time-Series Prediction:

- Have data up to present

- Predict value for future
- Special case of extrapolation

Regression with Noise

Model:

$$r^t = f(x^t) + \varepsilon$$

Where:

- $f(x)$: Unknown function to approximate
- ε : Random noise

Noise Sources:

- Extra hidden variables not observed
- Can write as: $r^t = f^*(x^t, z^t)$
- z^t : Hidden variables

Error Functions

Empirical Error (Mean Squared Error):

$$E(g|X) = (1/N) \sum_{t=1}^N [r^t - g(x^t)]^2$$

Where:

- $g(x^t)$: Output by our model
- r^t : Actual output
- Goal: Minimize this error

19. Linear and Polynomial Regression

Linear Regression (Single Input)

Model:

$$g(x|w_0, w_1) = w_0 + w_1 x$$

Parameters: w_0 (intercept) and w_1 (slope)

Optimization:

- Take partial derivatives of E with respect to w_0 and w_1
- Set equal to 0
- Solve for the two unknowns

Solution (Least Squares):

$$w_1 = \frac{\sum (x^t - \bar{x})(r^t - \bar{r})}{\sum (x^t - \bar{x})^2}$$

$$w_0 = \bar{r} - w_1 \bar{x}$$

Where:

- $\bar{x}$: Mean of x values
- $\bar{r}$: Mean of r values

Vector Form:

$$w = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T r$$

Polynomial Regression

When to Use: If linear model too simple (large approximation error)

Quadratic Model:

$$g(x | w_0, w_1, w_2) = w_0 + w_1 x + w_2 x^2$$

General Polynomial (Order k):

$$g(x | w) = w_0 + w_1 x + w_2 x^2 + \dots + w_k x^k$$

Parameters: $w_0, w_1, w_2, \dots, w_k$

Matrix Form: Still solvable using:

$$w = (X^T X)^{-1} X^T r$$

Where X contains powers of x

Multivariate Linear Regression

Problem: Sales depends on multiple factors:

- Advertisement (x_1)
- Fuel price (x_2)
- Interest rate (x_3)

Model:

$$\text{Sales} = w_0 + w_1 \times \text{Advertisement} + w_2 \times \text{Interest_Rate} + w_3 \times \text{Fuel_Price}$$

Parameters: w_0, w_1, w_2, w_3 **Dimension of Problem:**

- Number of features (d)
- Model order
- Sample size needed

Key Insight: As model order or number of features increases, need larger dataset to determine parameters.

Goodness of Fit Measures

1. Relative Square Error (RSE):

$$\text{ERSE} = \frac{\sum [r^t - g(x^t)]^2}{\sum [r^t - \bar{r}]^2}$$

Interpretation:

- ERSE = 1: Prediction as good as predicting average
- ERSE = 0: Perfect fit

2. Coefficient of Determination (R^2):

$$R^2 = 1 - \text{ERSE}$$

Interpretation:

- R^2 close to 1: Good fit
- $R^2 = 0$: Model no better than mean
- $R^2 < 0$: Model worse than mean

For regression to be useful: Require R^2 close to 1

Probabilistic Interpretation

Assumption: Noise ε is Gaussian with:

- Mean = 0
- Variance = σ^2

Model:

$$r = g(x|\theta) + \varepsilon$$

Log Likelihood:

$$L = \log p(r|x, \theta) = -N/2 \log(2\pi\sigma^2) - (1/2\sigma^2) \sum [r^t - g(x^t|\theta)]^2$$

Maximum Likelihood Estimation:

- Maximizing log likelihood
- Equivalent to minimizing squared error
- Parameters that minimize MSE are **Least Squares Estimates**

Part 6: Model Selection

20. Model Selection and Generalization

The Ill-Posed Problem

Example: Boolean Function

- Number of inputs = d (e.g., x_1, x_2)
- Training instances = 2^d (e.g., 00, 01, 10, 11)
- Number of possible outputs = $2^{(2^d)}$

For $d=2$:

- 4 possible inputs
- 16 possible functions ($h_1, h_2, \dots, h_{16}$)

Problem:

- Each training example removes inconsistent hypotheses
- Example: ($x_1=0, x_2=1$) $\rightarrow$ output=0 removes 8 hypotheses
- To end with unique hypothesis, need 2^d training examples

With Small Training Set ($N < 2^d$):

- After N examples, remain $2^{(2^d-N)}$ possible functions
- **Ill-posed problem:** Data not sufficient for unique solution
- Example: If $d=2, N=3$, then $2^{(2^2-3)} = 2$ functions remain

Solution: Inductive Bias

Definition: The set of assumptions we make to have learning possible.

Examples of Inductive Bias:

1. Family Car Example:

- Assumption 1: Shape is a rectangle
- Assumption 2: Choose rectangle with largest margin

2. Linear Regression:

- Assumption: Function is linear

3. Polynomial Regression:

- Assumption: Function is polynomial of specific order

Key Insight: Learning is **not possible** without inductive bias.

21. Inductive Bias

What is Inductive Bias?

Formal Definition: The set of assumptions that the learner uses to predict outputs for inputs it has not encountered.

Purpose: Makes learning possible by restricting hypothesis space.

Types of Inductive Bias

1. Language Bias:

- Restricts hypothesis space H
- Example: "Consider only polynomials up to degree k "
- Example: "Use only axis-aligned rectangles"

2. Search Bias:

- Preference for certain hypotheses over others
- Example: "Choose simplest hypothesis"
- Example: "Prefer hypothesis with largest margin"

Examples in Different Contexts

Classification:

- Rectangle shape (language bias)
- Largest margin (search bias)
- Axis-aligned vs. rotated rectangles

Regression:

- Linear function (language bias)
- Polynomial of order k (language bias)
- Least squares solution (search bias)

Neural Networks:

- Network architecture (language bias)
- Initialization strategy (search bias)
- Regularization (search bias)

Choosing the Right Bias

This is the problem of **model selection**:

- Choosing between possible hypothesis classes H
- Trade-off between:
 - Simplicity (fewer parameters)
 - Flexibility (capturing complex patterns)

22. Underfitting and Overfitting

Generalization

Definition: How well a model trained on the training set predicts the right output for new instances.

Goal: Match complexity of hypothesis class H with complexity of underlying function.

Underfitting

Definition: Hypothesis class H is **less complex** than the true function.

Characteristics:

- Model too simple
- **High bias, low variance**
- Poor fit to training data
- Poor performance on test data

Example:

- Trying to fit a line to data from a cubic polynomial
- Linear model for clearly non-linear relationship

Effect:

- As we increase complexity, training error **decreases**
- Model can't capture true pattern

Overfitting

Definition: Hypothesis class H is **more complex** than needed.

Characteristics:

- Model too complex
- **Low bias, high variance**
- Excellent fit to training data (including noise)
- Poor performance on new data

Example:

- Fitting 6th order polynomial to noisy data from 3rd order polynomial
- Model learns noise instead of signal

Effect:

- Training error very low
- Test error high
- Model doesn't generalize

The Triple Trade-off

Three factors interact:

1. **Complexity** of hypothesis class (capacity)
2. **Amount** of training data
3. **Generalization** error on new examples

Key Insights:

- More training data helps, but only up to a point
- Right complexity depends on amount of data
- Need balance between all three factors

Visual Understanding

Underfitting:

True function: $y = x^3$
Model: $y = mx + b$ (straight line)
Result: Can't capture curvature

Good Fit:

True function: $y = x^3$
Model: $y = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$
Result: Captures pattern well

Overfitting:

True function: $y = x^3$ (with noise)
Model: $y = \text{polynomial of degree 10}$
Result: Fits every point including noise

23. Bias-Variance Tradeoff

Mathematical Framework

Expected squared error at point x :

$$E[(r - g(x))^2] = \sigma^2 + E[(g(x) - E[r|x])^2]$$

Decomposition:

$$E[(r - g(x))^2] = \text{Noise} + (\text{Bias}^2 + \text{Variance})$$

Where:

- σ^2 : Variance of noise (irreducible error)
- **Bias**²: How much $g(x)$ deviates from true function
- **Variance**: How much $g(x)$ fluctuates with different datasets

Components Explained

1. Noise (σ^2):

- Irreducible error
- Present in data
- Cannot be eliminated by better model

2. Bias:

$$\text{Bias}[g(x)] = E[g(x)] - E[r|x]$$

- Measures systematic error
- How much estimator is wrong on average
- Disregards effect of varying samples

3. Variance:

$$\text{Var}[g(x)] = E[(g(x) - E[g(x)])^2]$$

- Measures sensitivity to training data
- How much $g(x)$ fluctuates around expected value
- Varies as sample varies

The Dilemma

To Decrease Bias:

- Model should be **flexible**
- At risk of having **high variance**
- Can fit complex patterns
- But sensitive to data variations

To Decrease Variance:

- Keep model **simple**
- At risk of having **high bias**
- Stable predictions
- But may miss important patterns

Optimal Model:

- Best trade-off between bias and variance
- Minimizes total error
- Depends on problem and data

Polynomial Order Example

As polynomial order increases:

Low Order (e.g., degree 1):

- **High bias** - can't fit curvature
- **Low variance** - stable across datasets
- **Underfitting**

Medium Order (e.g., degree 3):

- **Medium bias** - reasonable fit
- **Medium variance** - some sensitivity
- **Good fit**

High Order (e.g., degree 10):

- **Low bias** - fits training data well
- **High variance** - very sensitive to data
- **Overfitting**

Practical Implications

1. Model Complexity:

- Simple models: High bias, low variance
- Complex models: Low bias, high variance

2. Training Data Size:

- Small datasets: Prefer simple models (avoid variance)
- Large datasets: Can use complex models

3. Noise Level:

- High noise: Prefer simple models
- Low noise: Can use complex models

4. Ensemble Methods:

- Average many high-variance models
- Reduces variance while maintaining low bias
- Example: Random Forests

24. Cross-Validation

Purpose

Model Selection: Choose optimal model complexity

- Too simple → underfitting
- Too complex → overfitting
- Need systematic way to find sweet spot

Basic Approach

Split data into two parts:

1. **Training set** - train models
2. **Validation set** - test models

Process:

1. Train models of different complexities on training set
2. Evaluate each on validation set
3. Choose model with best validation performance

Performance vs. Complexity

Training Error:

- Decreases as complexity increases
- Always goes down or stays same
- Not reliable for model selection

Validation Error:

- Decreases initially
- Reaches minimum at optimal complexity
- Increases beyond optimal point (overfitting)

The "Elbow":

- Point where validation error stops decreasing
- Indicates optimal complexity level
- Balance between bias and variance

k-Fold Cross-Validation

Procedure:

1. Divide data into k equal parts (folds)
2. For each fold i:
 - Train on remaining k-1 folds
 - Test on fold i
3. Average performance across all k folds

Advantages:

- Uses all data for both training and testing
- More reliable estimate of performance
- Reduces variance in estimates

Common choices:

- $k=5$ (5-fold CV)
- $k=10$ (10-fold CV)
- $k=N$ (Leave-One-Out CV)

Other Model Selection Methods

1. Regularization:

- Add penalty for model complexity
- Examples: L1 (Lasso), L2 (Ridge)

2. Akaike Information Criterion (AIC):

- Balances fit quality and complexity
- Penalizes number of parameters

3. Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC):

- Similar to AIC
- Stronger penalty for complexity

4. Structural Risk Minimization:

- Theoretical framework
- Based on VC dimension

5. Minimum Description Length:

- Information-theoretic approach
- Balances model complexity and data fit

6. Bayesian Model Selection:

- Uses posterior probabilities
- Incorporates prior beliefs

Part 7: Advanced Classification

25. Dimensions of Supervised ML

Three Key Decisions

To build a good approximation $g(x|\theta)$ to desired output r , must make three decisions:

1. Model $g(\cdot | \theta)$

Definition:

- Defines the **hypothesis class H**
- $g(\cdot)$: The model structure
- θ : Parameters to be learned
- Particular θ value instantiates one hypothesis $h \in H$

Examples:

Class Learning:

- Model: Rectangle
- Parameters θ : Four coordinates (p_1, p_2, e_1, e_2)

Linear Regression:

- Model: Linear function $g(x | m, c) = mx + c$
- Parameters θ : Slope (m) and intercept (c)
- Example: $y = 2x + 5$ where $m=2, c=5$

Decision Process:

- Model (inductive bias) fixed by **system designer**
- Based on knowledge of application
- Hypothesis tuned by **learning algorithm**
- Using training set sampled from $p(x, r)$

2. Loss Function $L(\cdot)$

Purpose: Compute difference between desired output r^t and approximation $g(x^t | \theta)$

Total Error:

$$E(\theta | X) = \sum_{t=1}^N L(r^t, g(x^t | \theta))$$

Examples:

Classification (0/1 Loss):

$$L(r, g(x)) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } r = g(x) \\ 1 & \text{if } r \neq g(x) \end{cases}$$

Checks for equality.

Regression (Squared Error):

$$L(r, g(x)) = [r - g(x)]^2$$

Uses ordering information for distance.

3. Optimization Procedure

Goal: Find θ^* that minimizes total error

Formula:

$$\theta^* = \arg \min_{\theta} E(\theta|X)$$

Where "arg min" returns the argument that minimizes.

Considerations:

Analytical Solution:

- Polynomial regression: Can solve analytically
- Closed-form solution exists

Iterative Methods:

- Other models need iterative optimization
- Complexity becomes important factor

Local vs. Global Minima:

- **Single minimum:** Globally optimal solution
- **Multiple minima:** Locally optimal solutions
- Affects optimization strategy

Success Requirements

For the approach to work well:

1. **Sufficient Capacity:**

- Hypothesis class H should be large enough
- Must include (approximately) the unknown function
- Generated the data in noisy form

2. **Enough Data:**

- Sufficient training data to pinpoint correct hypothesis
- From the hypothesis class
- More complex models need more data

3. **Good Optimization:**

- Effective method to find correct hypothesis
- Given the training data
- Avoid local minima when possible

26. Parametric Classification

Problem Setup

Goal: Classify based on continuous features using probabilistic approach

Posterior Probability:

$$P(C_i | x) = p(x | C_i) P(C_i) / p(x)$$

Discriminant Function:

$$g_i(x) = \log P(C_i | x) = \log p(x | C_i) + \log P(C_i) - \log p(x)$$

Since $\log p(x)$ same for all classes, can be ignored:

$$g_i(x) = \log p(x | C_i) + \log P(C_i)$$

Gaussian Assumption

Assume $p(x | C_i)$ is Gaussian:

$$p(x | C_i) = (1/\sqrt{2\pi\sigma_i^2}) \exp(-(x-\mu_i)^2/(2\sigma_i^2))$$

Discriminant becomes:

$$g_i(x) = -(x-\mu_i)^2/(2\sigma_i^2) - \frac{1}{2}\log(2\pi\sigma_i^2) + \log P(C_i)$$

Example: Car Sales

Scenario:

- Car company selling K different car types
- x = customer's annual income
- $P(C_i)$ = Proportion of customers buying car type i
- μ_i = Mean annual income of customers buying car i
- σ_i^2 = Variance of annual income for car i

Parameter Estimation

When $P(C_i)$, μ_i , σ_i^2 unknown:

Prior Probability:

$$\hat{P}(C_i) = N_i / N$$

Where N_i = number of samples in class C_i

Mean:

$$\hat{\mu}_i = (1/N_i) \sum_{t \in C_i} x^t$$

Variance:

$$\hat{\sigma}_i^2 = (1/N_i) \sum_{t \in C_i} (x^t - \hat{\mu}_i)^2$$

Special Cases

1. Equal Priors and Equal Variances

If $P(C_i)$ same for all classes and $\sigma_i^2 = \sigma^2$:

$$g_i(x) = -(x - \mu_i)^2 / (2\sigma^2)$$

Decision Rule: Assign x to class with **nearest mean**

Formula:

$$\text{Choose } C_i \text{ if } |x - \mu_i| < |x - \mu_j| \text{ for all } j \neq i$$

2. Two Classes with Equal Variances

Decision boundary:

$$x^* = (\mu_1 + \mu_2) / 2$$

Interpretation:

- Single threshold
- Linear decision boundary
- Midpoint between class means

3. Two Classes with Unequal Variances

Result:

- **Two thresholds** possible
 - Quadratic decision boundary
 - Posteriors intersect at two points
-

27. Parameter Estimation

Multivariate Data

Setup:

$$X = [x^1, x^2, \dots, x^N]^T$$

Where:

- d columns represent d variables/features/attributes
- N rows represent N observations/examples/instances

Example: Loan Application

- N customers
- Features: age, annual income, assets

Sample Statistics

1. Mean Vector:

$$\hat{\mu} = (1/N) \sum_{t=1}^N x^t$$

Each element is mean of one column.

2. Variance:

$$\sigma_i^2 = (1/N) \sum_{t=1}^N (x_i^t - \mu_i)^2$$

3. Covariance:

$$\sigma_{ij} = (1/N) \sum_{t=1}^N (x_i^t - \mu_i)(x_j^t - \mu_j)$$

With $i=j$: $\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ji} = \sigma_{ii} = \sigma_i^2$

4. Covariance Matrix:

$$\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} \sigma_{11} & \sigma_{12} & \dots & \sigma_{1d} \\ \sigma_{21} & \sigma_{22} & \dots & \sigma_{2d} \\ \dots & \dots & \dots & \dots \\ \sigma_{d1} & \sigma_{d2} & \dots & \sigma_{dd} \end{bmatrix}$$

Properties:

- Diagonal elements: variances
- Off-diagonal elements: covariances
- Symmetric matrix
- Size: d×d

Matrix notation:

$$\Sigma = (1/N) \sum^t (x^t - \mu)(x^t - \mu)^T$$

5. Correlation:

$$\rho_{ij} = \sigma_{ij} / (\sigma_i \sigma_j)$$

Normalized between -1 and +1.

6. Correlation Matrix R: Contains all correlation coefficients ρ_{ij}

28. Multivariate Normal Distribution

Definition

Univariate Normal:

- Single variable
- Parameters: μ (mean), σ^2 (variance)

Multivariate Normal:

- d-dimensional vector x
- Parameters: μ (mean vector), Σ (covariance matrix)

Notation:

$$x \sim N(\mu, \Sigma)$$

Probability Density Function

General Form:

$$p(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{((2\pi)^{d/2} |\Sigma|^{1/2})} \exp(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x}-\mu)^T \Sigma^{-1}(\mathbf{x}-\mu))$$

Mahalanobis Distance

Definition:

$$D^2 = (\mathbf{x} - \mu)^T \Sigma^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \mu)$$

Properties:

- Accounts for correlations between variables
- Variables with larger variance receive less weight
- Defines d-dimensional hyper-ellipsoid centered at μ
- Shape and orientation defined by Σ

Interpretation:

- Small $D^2 \rightarrow$ sample close to mean
- Large $D^2 \rightarrow$ sample far from mean
- Accounts for covariance structure

Bivariate Case (d=2)

Mean vector:

$$\mu = [\mu_1, \mu_2]^T$$

Covariance matrix:

$$\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} \sigma_1^2 & \sigma_{12} \\ \sigma_{12} & \sigma_2^2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Joint density:

$$p(x_1, x_2) = \frac{1}{(2\pi\sigma_1\sigma_2\sqrt{1-\rho^2})} \exp(-\frac{1}{2}[(z_1^2 - 2\rho z_1 z_2 + z_2^2)/(1-\rho^2)])$$

Where:

- $z_1 = (x_1 - \mu_1)/\sigma_1$ (standardized variables)
- $z_2 = (x_2 - \mu_2)/\sigma_2$
- $\rho = \sigma_{12}/(\sigma_1\sigma_2)$ (correlation)

This is called z-normalization.

Special Cases

1. Independent Variables (Naive Case)

When components independent and identically distributed:

$\Sigma = \text{diagonal matrix}$
 $\Sigma^{-1} = \text{diagonal matrix}$

Joint density becomes:

$$p(x) = p(x_1) \times p(x_2) \times \dots \times p(x^d)$$

Product of individual univariate densities.

Example with $\sigma^2 = 1$:

$$p(x) = (1/(2\pi)^{(d/2)}) \exp(-\frac{1}{2}\sum_i x_i^2)$$

2. Projection Property

If W is $d \times k$ matrix with rank $k < d$:

$$y = W^T x$$

Then:

$$y \sim N(W^T \mu, W^T \Sigma W)$$

Meaning:

- Projecting d -dimensional normal to k -dimensional space
- Result is k -dimensional normal
- Preserves normality under linear transformation

29. Multivariate Classification

Problem Setup

Goal: Predict car type based on customer data

Components:

- **Classes:** Different car types (i)
- **Features:** $x = [\text{age}, \text{income}]^T$
- μ_i : Mean vector for class i
- Σ_i : Covariance matrix for class i

Example:

- μ_i = mean [age, income] of customers buying car i
- σ_1^2 = variance of age in class i
- σ_2^2 = variance of income in class i
- σ_{12} = covariance of age and income in class i

Discriminant Functions

Conditional density:

$$p(x|C_i) \sim N(\mu_i, \Sigma_i)$$

Discriminant:

$$g_i(x) = -\frac{1}{2}\log|\Sigma_i| - \frac{1}{2}(x-\mu_i)^T \Sigma_i^{-1}(x-\mu_i) + \log P(C_i)$$

Expanded form:

$$g_i(x) = w_i^T x + w_{i0}$$

Where:

$$\begin{aligned} w_i &= \Sigma_i^{-1} \mu_i \\ w_{i0} &= -\frac{1}{2} \mu_i^T \Sigma_i^{-1} \mu_i - \frac{1}{2} \log|\Sigma_i| + \log P(C_i) \end{aligned}$$

Parameter Requirements

Number of parameters:

- **Means:** $K \times d$
- **Covariances:** $K \times d(d+1)/2$
- **Total:** $K \times [d + d(d+1)/2]$

Challenges with small samples:

- Σ_i may be **singular** (non-invertible)

- $|\Sigma_i|$ may be very small
- Estimates unreliable

Solutions:

1. Decrease dimensionality
2. Use common covariance matrix

Simplifications

1. Common Covariance Matrix ($\Sigma_i = \Sigma$)

Parameters:

- Means: $K \times d$
- Shared covariance: $d(d+1)/2$
- Total: $K \times d + d(d+1)/2$

Result:

- **Linear decision boundaries**
- More stable with limited data

Discriminant:

$$g_i(x) = w_i^T x + w_{i0}$$

Where:

$$w_i = \Sigma^{-1} \mu_i$$

$$w_{i0} = -\frac{1}{2} \mu_i^T \Sigma^{-1} \mu_i + \log P(C_i)$$

With equal priors: Assign to class with smallest Mahalanobis distance.

2. Naive Bayes Classifier

Assumption: Features are independent

$$\Sigma = \text{diagonal matrix}$$

Simplification:

$$p(x|C_i) = \prod_j p(x_j|C_i)$$

Advantages:

- Drastically reduces parameters
- Fast training and prediction
- Works well even when independence violated

3. Nearest Mean Classifier

Assumptions:

- Common covariance
- All variances equal
- Features independent
- Result: $\Sigma = \sigma^2 I$

Distance: Euclidean distance

Discriminant:

$$g_i(x) = -||x - \mu_i||^2 / (2\sigma^2) + \log P(C_i)$$

With equal priors:

$$g_i(x) = -||x - \mu_i||^2$$

Decision: Assign to class with nearest mean

4. Further Simplification

If μ_i have similar norms:

- Can neglect norm terms
- Even simpler decision rule

Variance Reduction

Trade-off:

- **Simplicity** (few parameters)
- **Generality** (capture complex patterns)

Strategies:

1. Diagonal covariance (independence)
2. Shared covariance (common Σ)
3. Equal variances (all σ^2 equal)
4. Combinations

Effect:

- Decreases parameters
- Introduces **bias**
- Reduces **variance**

Regularized Discriminant Analysis

Weighted combination:

$$\Sigma_i(\alpha, \beta) = \alpha I + (1-\alpha)[\beta \Sigma + (1-\beta)\Sigma_i]$$

Where $\alpha, \beta \in [0,1]$

Special cases:

- ($\alpha=0, \beta=0$): Quadratic classifier
- ($\alpha=0, \beta=1$): Linear classifier
- ($\alpha=1, \beta=0$): Nearest mean classifier

Tuning: Use validation set to select optimal α and β .

Decision Boundary Types

Linear Classifier:

- Straight line/hyperplane
- Shared covariance
- Fast, interpretable

Quadratic Classifier:

- Curved boundary (ellipse, parabola, hyperbola)
- Class-specific covariances
- More flexible

Nearest Mean:

- Can be piecewise linear
- Depends on class means and priors
- Simplest classifier

30. Discrete Features Classification

Problem Setup

Discrete attributes: Variables taking one of n different values

Examples:

- Color $\in \{\text{red, green, blue}\}$
- Pixel $\in \{0, 1\}$
- Word presence $\in \{0, 1\}$

Binary Features

Model:

$$p(x|C_i) = \prod_j p_{ij}^{x_j} (1-p_{ij})^{1-x_j}$$

Where:

- p_{ij} : Probability feature $j=1$ in class i
- x_j : Binary feature (0 or 1)

Discriminant:

$$g_i(x) = \sum_j [x_j \log p_{ij} + (1-x_j) \log(1-p_{ij})] + \log P(C_i)$$

Note: Linear in x

Parameter estimation:

$$\hat{p}_{ij} = (\# \text{ times feature } j=1 \text{ in class } i) / (\text{total samples in class } i)$$

Application: Document Classification

Bag of Words:

1. Choose d words a priori (vocabulary)
2. Each document $\rightarrow$ binary vector
 - $x_j = 1$ if word j appears
 - $x_j = 0$ otherwise

After training:

- p_{ij} estimates probability word j appears in document type i
- Classify new documents based on word presence

Multinomial Features

Feature $x_j \in \{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_m\}$

Model:

$$p(x|C_i) = \prod_j \prod_k p_{ijk} I(x_j = v_k)$$

Where:

- p_{ijk} : $P(x_j=v_k | C_i)$
- $I(x_j=v_k)$: Indicator function

Independence assumption:

$$p(x|C_i) = \prod_j p(x_j|C_i)$$

Discriminant:

$$g_i(x) = \sum_j \log p(x_j|C_i) + \log P(C_i)$$

Parameter estimation:

$$\hat{p}_{ijk} = (\# \text{ samples in } C_i \text{ where } x_j=v_k) / (\# \text{ samples in } C_i)$$

Practice Problems and Examples

Problem 1: Linear Regression

Dataset:

x_1	x_2	y
1	1	6.1
2	1	7.8
3	1	10.1
1	2	9.05
2	2	10.8
3	2	12.87
1	3	13
2	3	13.5
3	3	16.01

Test data:

x_1	x_2	
4	1	($y = ?$)

Tasks:

1. Develop linear regression model
2. Calculate training error
3. Calculate testing error
4. Predict y when $x_1=4.2$, $x_2=1.9$

Problem 2: Model Selection**Training data:**

x	y
1	5.1
2	10.8
3	21.1
1.5	7.65
2.5	15.8
3.5	26.5
1.8	9.5
2.2	12.5

Test data:

x	y
4.3	40.1
4	35.5

Tasks:

1. Fit linear model, find training error
2. Fit quadratic model, find training error
3. Fit 4th degree polynomial, find training error
4. Test all three on test data
5. Plot training vs testing error
6. Comment on underfitting/overfitting

Problem 3: Bias-Variance Analysis**Two classifiers:**

- Model A: Linear Classifier
- Model B: k-NN (K=5)

Results:

	Training Error	Test Error
Model A	15%	18%
Model B	3%	22%

Tasks:

1. Identify which has high bias/variance
2. Justify using bias-variance tradeoff
3. Suggest which to select

Problem 4: Parametric Classification

Given:

- Two classes ω_1, ω_2
- Prior: $P(\omega_1) = 0.6, P(\omega_2) = 0.4$
- $\omega_1: N(\mu_1=5, \sigma_1^2=4)$
- $\omega_2: N(\mu_2=10, \sigma_2^2=9)$

Tasks:

1. Calculate discriminant functions
2. Find decision boundary
3. Classify $x=7$
4. Calculate error probabilities

Problem 5: Document Classification

Features:

- x_1 : Presence of word "discount"
- x_2 : Presence of word "free"

Training data:

Class	x_1	x_2	Count
Spam	Yes	Yes	50
Spam	Yes	No	10
Spam	No	Yes	20
Spam	No	No	5
Ham	Yes	Yes	5
Ham	Yes	No	15
Ham	No	Yes	10
Ham	No	No	85

Tasks:

1. Estimate class conditional probabilities
 2. Estimate prior probabilities
 3. Classify document with $x=(\text{Yes}, \text{Yes})$
-

Summary and Key Takeaways

Fundamental Concepts

1. Machine Learning Paradigm

- Learn from examples, not explicit programming
- Requires: data, model, optimization
- Generalizes to new instances

2. Types of Learning

- Supervised: Classification and regression
- Unsupervised: Clustering, dimensionality reduction
- Reinforcement: Sequential decision making

3. Data Management

- Split: Training/Validation/Test
- Multiple runs for reliability
- Cross-validation for model selection

Learning Theory

4. Hypothesis Space

- Version space bounded by S and G
- VC dimension measures capacity
- PAC learning provides guarantees

5. Model Selection

- Inductive bias necessary for learning
- Underfitting vs overfitting
- Bias-variance tradeoff

Classification

6. Parametric Classification

- Assumes probabilistic model

- Gaussian assumption common
- Maximum likelihood estimation

7. Simplifications

- Common covariance → linear boundaries
- Independent features → Naive Bayes
- Equal variances → nearest mean

Regression

8. Linear Models

- Least squares estimation
- Closed-form solution
- R^2 for goodness of fit

9. Polynomial Models

- Higher order for complex patterns
- Risk of overfitting
- Cross-validation for selection

Evaluation

10. Performance Metrics

- Confusion matrix fundamentals
- Precision, Recall, F1-Score
- ROC curves and AUC

11. Model Complexity

- Training vs validation error
- Optimal complexity at elbow
- Multiple validation methods

Best Practices

12. Model Development

- Start simple, add complexity if needed
- Use validation for hyperparameter tuning
- Test set for final unbiased evaluation

13. Practical Considerations

- Missing values → imputation
- Discrete features → multinomial models
- Noise → prefer simple models

14. Trade-offs

- Bias vs Variance
- Complexity vs Interpretability
- Computation vs Accuracy

Textbook Reference

Source: "Introduction to Machine Learning" by Ethem Alpaydin, 4th Edition, MIT Press, 2020

End of Unit 1 Complete Notes